
COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS · JULY 2026

USCCA can't sell to New Yorkers.

They still rank for New York. Their New York content is wrong about our city. They have the funnel and no offer — we have the offer and no funnel.

FROM THEIR OWN MEMBERSHIP PAGE

“USCCA Membership is not available to residents of New Jersey, **New York** or Washington State.”

Subject

usconcealedcarry.com
Delta Defense, LLC

Compared against

CARRY — concierge platform
Concealed Knowledge — knowledge site

Prepared

13 July 2026
For partner review

01 The strategic read

USCCA is a national, insurance-backed subscription business. Its entire revenue product is legally unavailable in our market — yet it still owns New York search intent with content that is materially wrong about New York City.

~875k CLAIMED MEMBERS	\$39–59 PER MONTH, PER MEMBER	\$0 REVENUE THEY CAN EARN IN NY	~20x HOW WRONG THEIR NYC FEE IS
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NY State bars the self-defense liability insurance that anchors the USCCA bundle, so Delta Defense excludes NJ, NY and WA outright. The consequence is an **unmonetized funnel sitting directly on top of our customer**: a New Yorker searching “how do I get a carry permit” lands on a USCCA page, reads a stale four-step listicle, clicks through to a membership page, and is told they are ineligible.

THE OPENING

USCCA is not a competitor for our revenue. They are a **traffic reservoir with no drain**. The play is to out-rank and out-truth them on NY/NYC and become the obvious destination for the intent they cannot serve — before anyone else notices the gap.

02 What USCCA actually is

A **membership association**, not a permit service. Content and training are customer-acquisition assets for a recurring, insurance-backed subscription. Operated by Delta Defense, LLC (West Bend, WI), a licensed insurance agency in all 50 states.

TIER	PRICE	WHAT YOU GET
Gold	\$39/mo · \$399/yr	150+ video episodes · 30+ guides · Qualification Level 1 · LifeLock Standard
Platinum	\$49/mo · \$499/yr	290+ videos · 40+ guides · Levels 1–2 · quarterly Tactical Mastery + Attorney Insider series
Elite	\$59/mo · \$599/yr	430+ videos · 80+ guides · Levels 1–3 · priority service · full magazine archive

Every tier includes: Protector Academy (eLearning), *Concealed Carry Magazine*, self-defense liability insurance, a 24/7 Critical Response Team hotline, free store shipping, partner discounts, and an annual anniversary gift.

Secondary revenue: e-commerce store, the USCCA Expo (paid 3-day show), instructor certification, and the magazine. They run roughly ten subdomains — marketing, LMS, instructor certification, instructor search, an embeddable class-search widget, a member portal, a community forum, a store, an advocacy arm, and checkout.

03 Head to head

	USCCA	CONCEALED KNOWLEDGE	CARRY (gunlicensenyc)
Core promise	Be educated, trained, insured	Understand guns and gun law, plainly	Get your NYC license without getting denied
Geography	50 states — shallow	New York — deep	New York City — very deep
Model	Recurring subscription	Free, non-commercial by design	One-time fee \$499—\$1,999 + 10% marketplace take
Revenue in NY	\$0 — legally excluded	\$0 by design (top of funnel)	All of it
Depth on NYC	Four-step listicle. Wrong fees, wrong authority.	Ranked compliance guardrails, cited & dated	Versioned requirements registry, 24-document packet, pre-filing QA gate
Free entry point	Free portal account	Entire site	Eligibility quiz only
Two-sided supply	Instructors, ranges, attorneys, affiliates	—	Instructors (Stripe Connect), but private
Emotional register	Fear → preparedness “This is it. I might not make it...”	Calm → competence deliberately anti-tactical	Precision → control “The delay is the danger.”
Retention	Monthly sub, magazine, forum, insurance	None	3-year renewal cycle, nothing in between
Post-incident	24/7 response team + attorney network + insurance	—	Attorney referral seam only
Community	Forum, expo, member stories	—	—

04 Scorecard: what they do well, what they do badly

WHAT USCCA DOES WELL

- **A real free tier.**

A logged-in free portal account with genuine sample value — not a newsletter box. It is the top of a funnel we simply do not have.

- **Two-sided supply, everywhere.**

Certified instructors, partner ranges, an attorney network, and affiliates all market USCCA for free because USCCA sends them leads.

- **Distribution as a product.**

Their class-search is an embeddable, themed, parameterised widget — iframed into their own pages and syndicable to partners.

- **Named risk reversal.**

The trademarked “Bulletproof Guarantee” — 30 days, 100% back — repeated on every page next to a phone number.

- **Quantified trust, honestly footnoted.**

Big numbers do the persuading; a full methodology footnote does the ethics.

- **Narrative social proof.**

Named, photographed member stories of real incidents. Devastatingly effective.

- **Recurring revenue and LTV.**

Insurance + magazine + forum + store = a subscription people forget to cancel.

- **Free seminars as lead-gen.**

Attorney-led events, “plus a free book,” run nationwide.

WHAT USCCA DOES BADLY

- **Their New York page is wrong.**

It quotes “~\$20 initial license” — NYC is **\$340 + \$88.25** in fingerprints. Off by roughly twenty times.

- **Wrong authority.**

It tells applicants to “visit your local county sheriff or courthouse.” NYC applicants go to the NYPD License Division.

- **Silent on everything that matters.**

No character references, no cohabitant affidavits, no in-person interview, no social-media disclosure, no six-month training expiry, no six-month investigation timeline.

- **No model for may-issue.**

Their entire product assumes shall-issue: take a class, file a form, wait. That is useless where the application is an investigation.

- **Self-contradicting numbers.**

The same page claims 500,000 and 875,000 members. Copyright still reads 2003–2024.

- **The NY funnel dead-ends.**

They spend authority ranking for New York, then tell the visitor they are ineligible to buy.

- **Fear-first tone.**

Effective at national scale; corrosive to a trust-led, precision brand.

THE CREDIBILITY WEDGE

Concealed Knowledge already enforces what USCCA does not: every claim carries a **verified date, a cited source, and an anti-fabrication test gate**. A single page — “*NYC is not New York State*” — is a high-intent, high-authority SEO wedge against a twenty-year-old domain that is factually wrong about our city.

05 What we should add to compete

Seven borrowable mechanics, adapted — not copied. Ranked by value to us.

Tier 1 — build these

HIGH LEVERAGE

WHAT TO ADD	WHAT USCCA PROVES	HOW OURS DIFFERS
A free CARRY account	Their free portal account captures intent long before purchase.	Not a lead magnet — a genuinely useful artefact. Save your eligibility result, get your personalised NYC document checklist, get notified when a rule changes. We already generate all three.
NYC Firearms Attorney Network	Free for attorneys to join; USCCA gets a referral graph and an enormous trust signal.	Solves two problems at once: it is a growth channel <i>and</i> it clears our single biggest blocker — every rule in the requirements registry still sits at <code>needs_legal_review = true</code> . Recruit the network, get the sign-off, ship the credibility.
Public, embeddable instructor finder	Their class-search is public, themed, iframed and indexed.	Ours is locked inside the authenticated portal. Making it public seeds the supply side, gives instructors a reason to link to us, and ranks. The geo-matching already exists.
A named <i>process</i> guarantee	Risk reversal converts. Theirs is trademarked and everywhere.	We cannot — and must not — promise approval. But we can promise our own work: “If a packet we assemble is returned as incomplete, we refile free.” The CP-5 pre-filing gate makes this nearly costless to offer, and it is fully compliant.
Quantified, footnoted trust	Big numbers persuade; the methodology footnote keeps it honest.	Publish a live, dated counter: cases filed, packets assembled, documents verified, average days intake → filing. Our claim is “0 filed incomplete.” Never an approval rate.

Tier 2 — adapt

MEDIUM LEVERAGE

- **Application stories, not shootout stories.** Our version of “True Stories of Self-Defense” is anonymised, consented case narratives: *the sealed arrest he almost didn’t disclose; the reference letter that came back three weeks late*. They double as candor-doctrine teaching. This is our single most on-brand borrowable asset.
- **“Where can my NYC licence actually take me?”** Don’t fight them on the 50-state reciprocity map — it is the highest-traffic asset in the category and unwinnable. But NY reciprocity is uniquely brutal and it is the first question every newly licensed New Yorker asks. A narrow, defensible version of their biggest asset.

- **A free monthly webinar** — “*What actually gets people denied in NYC*” — co-hosted with an attorney from the network. Feeds the consultation booking flow. Low cost, extremely high intent.
- **Sell the lead flow to instructors.** USCCA's real insight is that instructors will pay for *demand*, not certification. That is the flywheel — lead with it in recruiting copy.

Do not copy BRAND RISK

- **Self-defense liability insurance.** This is precisely *why* they cannot sell in New York. Do not go near it.
- **The fear register.** “Have you ever genuinely feared for your life?” works for a national mass-market membership. It would actively damage both our brands. Our fear is bureaucratic, not violent: *the delay is the danger*.
- **Gear commerce and affiliate links.** Concealed Knowledge's credibility rests on “nothing for sale.” That constraint is an asset. Don't trade it for margin.
- **Sloppy numbers.** Their member count contradicts itself within a single page. Being dated and sourced is our entire differentiator.

06 Gaps in our own stack that this exposes

GAP	EVIDENCE	WHY USCCA MAKES IT URGENT
Placeholder contact details live in production	config/brand.ts still ships carry.example and (212) 555-0142	USCCA puts a real, staffed 24/7 phone number in every footer. A fake number on a page selling \$1,999 of trust is a trust-killer. Fix today.
No analytics anywhere	No PostHog, Plausible or GA in either repo	We cannot measure the funnel we are trying to win. Concealed Knowledge already has a disabled cookieless hook — turn it on.
No attorney sign-off	Every registry rule at needs_legal_review = true; CK legal copy marked “pending expert review”	The Attorney Network is simultaneously the fix and the growth channel.
Payments and email both flag-gated off	STRIPE_ENABLED=false, no RESEND_API_KEY	They have a three-click checkout. We have “request an invoice.”
No free tier, no logged-out value	Portal is authenticated-only	Their free account is the top of a funnel we do not have at all.
Knowledge site on a project-page URL	Still on a /Ccw GitHub Pages basename; concealedknowledge.com bought but unpointed	Every day on a basename is SEO left on the table against a WordPress site with twenty years of domain authority.

GAP	EVIDENCE	WHY USCCA MAKES IT URGENT
No retention loop	A 3-year renewal reminder and nothing in between	Their forum + magazine + subscription compounds LTV. Ours does not compound at all.

07 Recommended sequence

1	Fix the trust basics Real phone and email in config/brand.ts. Turn analytics on. Point concealedknowledge.com at the knowledge site.	DAYS CRITICAL
2	Build the NYC content wedge A sourced, dated page showing exactly what national guides get wrong about NYC — fees, authority, references, timeline. Links straight into CARRY.	1 WEEK HIGH
3	Name and publish the process guarantee “Returned incomplete? We refile free.” A copy and policy change, backed by a QA gate we already run.	DAYS HIGH
4	Ship a free CARRY account Eligibility quiz → saved personalised checklist → email on rule change. Requires turning Resend on.	2 WEEKS HIGH
5	Launch the NYC Firearms Attorney Network Free to join, public directory. Clears the legal-review blocker across the entire requirements registry.	4 WEEKS COMPOUNDING
6	Public, embeddable instructor finder Unlocks the marketplace supply side and gives instructors a reason to link to us.	3 WEEKS COMPOUNDING
7	“Where can my NYC licence take me?” + application stories A narrow reciprocity tool, and five anonymised, consented case narratives.	ONGOING MEDIUM

THE ONE-LINE READ

USCCA is a national, insurance-backed subscription that is **legally forbidden from selling to New Yorkers** — yet still owns the New York search results with content that is wrong about our city. They have the funnel and no offer. We have the offer and no funnel. **Everything above is about closing that gap before someone else notices it.**

Sources

usconcealedcarry.com — homepage, statistics, membership funnel · /membership/ — tiers, insurance, the NY/NJ/WA exclusion · /resources/how-to-get-a-concealed-carry-permit/ — 50-state hub · /resources/how-to-get-a-concealed-carry-permit/new-york/ — the state NY content · /resources/ — content inventory · /partner/ — instructors, ranges, Attorney Network, affiliates. All pages retrieved 13 July 2026.

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